

HITS™

User Guide & Reference Manual

Hobby Inventory & Profit Tax Tracking

Beta Edition

Distribution-ready working draft for onboarding, beta testing, and day-to-day reference.

This guide is written for new users who need to understand how to use HITS™ from account creation through year-end reporting.

Important Note

This manual is intended to help users operate HITS™ and understand the records the system creates. It is not tax, legal, or accounting advice. Users should consult a qualified tax professional for specific tax questions. The purpose of HITS™ is to organize business data so users and their tax preparers have cleaner records to work from.

The guide uses plain-English explanations and step-by-step procedures. Because HITS™ is being prepared for beta distribution, some labels or navigation may change slightly as the application is refined. The core workflow described here reflects the tested system: purchases become orders, orders are processed into inventory, inventory is sold or otherwise removed, and reports summarize the business activity.

Table of Contents

1. Welcome to HITS™
2. Creating an Account and Logging In
3. First-Time Setup
4. Dashboard and Navigation
5. Orders and Imports
6. Combining Orders
7. Orders Received
8. Inventory Fundamentals
9. Entering Inventory Manually
10. Bulk Inventory Import
11. Managing Inventory
12. Selling Inventory
13. Shipping Profiles
14. Expenses
15. Giveaways
16. Disposal and Write-Offs
17. Starting Inventory
18. Tax Year Settings and Locking
19. Backup and Restore Points
20. Reports Center
21. HITS Pulse™
22. Action Needed and Troubleshooting
23. Best Practices
24. Year-End Checklist
25. Glossary

1. Welcome to HITS™

What HITS™ Is

HITS™ stands for Hobby Inventory & Profit Tax Tracking. It was built for hobby sellers who need a practical way to track purchases, inventory, sales, expenses, shipping, profits, and tax-related records without relying on scattered spreadsheets. HITS™ connects the entire business workflow so that one action, such as recording a sale, can update inventory, realized cost of goods sold, profitability, reports, and year-end records.

The system is designed around the way hobby sellers actually operate. A seller may buy cards on Whatnot, pick up inventory at a card show, purchase a collection from someone locally, or bring inventory home from storage. Some purchases are imported from marketplace files. Others are entered manually. HITS™ supports both workflows.

Who This Guide Is For

- New users logging into HITS™ for the first time.
- Beta testers evaluating the application before full distribution.
- Hobby sellers moving away from spreadsheets.
- Sellers who need better cost basis, profit, expense, and tax records.
- Users who want a reference for common questions and troubleshooting.

The Core Workflow

Most HITS™ users follow the same general path: purchase inventory, bring those purchases into HITS™, create inventory records, sell inventory, track expenses, review reports, and lock the tax year when complete.

Stage	What Happens
Purchase	The user buys inventory from a marketplace, stream, card show, local seller, or collection.
Order	The purchase enters HITS™ as an order or is entered manually.
Orders Received	The purchase is reviewed and converted into inventory records.
Inventory	Items are available to search, edit, sell, give away, or dispose.
Sale	Revenue, fees, shipping, supplies, and profit details are recorded.
Reports	Business activity appears in financial, inventory, sales, tax, and operations reports.

Tax Lock	Completed tax years are reviewed, snapshotted, and locked.
----------	--

Best Practice: Do not think of HITS™ as only an inventory list. Think of it as a chain of business records. Better records at the beginning create better reporting at the end.

What HITS™ Tracks

- Inventory and cost basis.
- Imported purchases and order history.
- Manual inventory purchases.
- Sales, platform fees, shipping charged, postage, and supplies cost.
- Business expenses.
- Giveaways and promotional activity.
- Disposed or written-off inventory.
- Starting inventory and tax year locks.
- Restore points and data recovery checkpoints.
- Reports for profit, tax support, sales tax, inventory, operations, and CPA preparation.

2. Creating an Account and Logging In

Creating an Account

A new user begins by creating an account with an email address and password. The email address should be one the user checks regularly because it may be used for password recovery or account-related messages. After the account is created, the user signs in and lands inside the application.

- 1 Open the HITS™ login page.
- 2 Choose the create account option.
- 3 Enter an email address.
- 4 Create a secure password.
- 5 Submit the account form.
- 6 Verify the account if an email verification step is shown.
- 7 Return to the login page and sign in.

Logging In

Returning users enter their email address and password, then select Sign In. After a successful login, HITS™ opens the main application area. The first page a user sees may be the Dashboard or another default landing page depending on the current app configuration.

Password Reset

If a user forgets a password, the password reset option should be used rather than creating a second account. Multiple accounts can split inventory and reporting history, which makes business records harder to manage.

- 1 Select Forgot Password.
- 2 Enter the account email address.
- 3 Follow the reset instructions sent by email.
- 4 Create a new password.
- 5 Return to HITS™ and sign in.

First Login Expectations

On the first login, many dashboards, report cards, and totals may show zero. This is normal. HITS™ reports are based on inventory, sales, expenses, and tax-year records. As data is entered, the Dashboard and Reports Center begin to populate.

Common Question: Why does everything show zero after I log in?

Because no business activity has been entered yet. Import orders, create inventory, record sales, and add expenses to populate the system.

Duplicate	The system detected that the order or row already existed.
-----------	--

Bad Import Recovery

If a user imports the wrong file, imports duplicate-looking data, or sees unexpected results, the safest first step is to stop. Do not keep clicking around and creating more changes. Review the import results, check the affected records, and use restore points if necessary.

Before Large Imports: Create a manual restore point. Automatic restore points also exist, but a manual restore point gives the user a clearly named checkpoint before a large change.

Common Questions

Why did my order not import?

Possible reasons include duplicate detection, invalid file format, missing required data, or a corrupted export file. Review the import result details.

Why do I not see inventory after importing?

Imported orders do not automatically become inventory. They must be processed through Orders Received or inventory entry workflows first.

7. Orders Received

What Orders Received Is

Orders Received is the sorting tray between purchases and active inventory. Purchases can sit here while the user decides how to enter the items. Think of it as the workbench: inventory has been purchased, but the final inventory records have not been created yet.

Why Orders Received Exists

Many sellers do not want to create inventory immediately when a marketplace order imports. They may need to sort cards, identify players, group lots, assign costs, or decide how items should be listed. Orders Received gives users a place to do that work without prematurely creating active inventory.

Processing Workflow

- 1 Navigate to Orders -> Orders Received or use the Universal Search Bar up top..
- 2 Find the order or group to process.
- 3 Open the record.
- 4 Enter the inventory details needed for the items received.
- 5 Save the inventory records.
- 6 Return to Inventory and confirm the items are searchable and available.

What Happens After Saving

- Inventory records are created.
- Items become available for sale.
- Cost basis becomes part of reporting.
- Items can appear in search and inventory tables.
- Future sales can calculate realized cost of goods sold.

Common Mistakes

I imported orders but Inventory is empty.

This usually means the orders have not been processed through Orders Received yet. Importing is not the same thing as creating inventory.

I closed the page before finishing.

Return to Orders Received and continue processing. This workflow is intended to allow users to come back later.

8. Inventory Fundamentals

What Inventory Is

Inventory is the master list of items the business currently owns. In HITS™, inventory may include single cards, lots, sealed items, memorabilia, comics, coins, toys, and other collectibles. Inventory remains active until it is sold, given away, disposed, or otherwise removed from available stock.

Required Fields

Field	Why It Matters
Player/Item Name	Used for searching, identifying, selling, and HITS Pulse activity.
Cost	Used for profit, cost basis, realized COGS, tax support, and CPA reporting.

Recommended Optional Fields

- Brand, such as Topps, Panini, Upper Deck, Pokémon, or another product line.
- Year, such as 1989, 2024, or 2025.
- Card Number or item number.
- Condition, grade, or notes about quality.
- Category and subcategory when useful.
- Purchase source, platform, order number, or notes.

Cost Basis Explained

Cost basis is what the business paid for the item. If a card was purchased for \$5, its cost basis is \$5. If a collection was purchased for \$500, the user may need to allocate portions of that \$500 across the items being entered. Cost basis is one of the most important values in the system because it determines profit when the item sells.

Without cost basis, a sale may look more profitable than it really was. For example, selling a card for \$20 is not \$20 of profit if the card cost \$12 and shipping supplies were used. HITS™ needs cost, fees, postage, and supplies to calculate a useful profit picture.

Inventory Lifecycle

Status or Stage	Meaning
Available	The item is owned and available to sell.

Sold	The item was sold and should no longer be available.
Giveaway	The item was removed as promotional or marketing activity.
Disposed	The item was damaged, lost, unsellable, or otherwise removed without a sale.

Naming Items

Users should choose names that will make sense later. For sports cards, a simple player name is often best, with brand, year, and number in separate fields or notes. For non-sports items, use a clear product name. Consistent naming improves search for comps, sales entry, and reporting.

Common Inventory Problems

- Missing cost basis, which affects profit and tax reports.
- Duplicate entries from repeated imports or manual mistakes.
- Inconsistent item names that make search harder.
- Inventory created before the user has enough information.
- Items disposed or given away without notes.

Best Practices

- Enter cost basis immediately if not already pre-filled. Many details will be pre-filled if imported.
- Use consistent naming conventions.
- Add notes for anything that may be unclear later.
- Review Action Needed regularly.
- Avoid deleting inventory to solve business history problems; use sale reversal, giveaway, disposal, or restore points when appropriate.

9. Entering Inventory Manually

When Manual Entry Is Used

Manual inventory entry is useful when inventory does not come from an import file. Common examples include card show purchases, collection purchases, trades, items found in existing storage, or purchases from a person directly.

Manual Entry Workflow

- 1 Navigate to Inventory.
- 2 Choose the option to create or add inventory.
- 3 Enter Player/Item Name.
- 4 Enter Cost.
- 5 Add recommended details such as brand, year, number, condition, and notes.
- 6 Save the item.
- 7 Search inventory to confirm it was created.

Card Show Example

A user buys five cards at a card show for a total of \$40. If each card has a clear purchase price, enter each card with its actual cost. If the purchase was a bundle, the user should allocate the total cost in a reasonable way so each item has a cost basis. The goal is not perfection for every low-value item; the goal is consistent business records that support profit and tax reporting.

Collection Purchase Example

A user buys a collection for \$500. Some items may be high-value singles and others may be bulk. The user can create inventory records for the most important items and assign portions of the purchase cost to them. Bulk or lower-value items can be tracked as lots when appropriate. Notes should explain that the items came from a collection purchase.

Manual Entry Mistakes

- Entering zero cost when the item had an actual purchase cost. The IRS ALWAYS wants a cost.
- Forgetting where the item came from.
- Using vague names like "card" or "lot" without searchable details such as team or player names in the notes.
- Creating too many tiny records when a group or what we call a lot would be more practical.

10. Bulk Inventory Import

What Bulk Import Is

Bulk Inventory Import allows users to upload a CSV file to create many inventory records at once. This is especially useful for sellers moving from a spreadsheet or entering a large batch of items that did not come from marketplace order imports.

Minimum Required Information

The bulk import workflow is designed to be simple. The minimum required fields are Player/Item Name and Cost. More fields can be entered if available, but users should not be blocked from getting basic inventory into the system.

Recommended Columns - Template can be downloaded

- Player/Item Name
- Cost
- Quantity
- Brand
- Year
- Card Number
- Condition
- Purchase Date
- Purchased From
- Platform
- Order Number
- Notes

Bulk Import Workflow

- 1 Navigate to Inventory -> Add Inventory in Bulk.
- 2 Download the template.
- 3 Fill in the CSV file.
- 4 Save the file as CSV.
- 5 Upload the file.
- 6 Review imported, skipped, and error counts.

- 7 Correct any errors and re-upload if needed.
- 8 Verify the imported items appear in Inventory.

Duplicate Protection

Bulk import should protect users from accidentally re-uploading the same sheet and duplicating every row. If a user fixes errors and re-uploads, the system should import only what still needs to be imported and skip records already handled when duplicate protection applies.

Common Bulk Import Questions

Why are optional fields useful?

Optional fields reduce future typing. A user can enter only name and cost, but more complete data improves search and reporting.

11. Managing Inventory

Searching Inventory

Search helps users find items quickly. Users may search by player name, item name, brand, notes, or other identifying details depending on the current page. Search should be used before creating duplicate entries unless it's a duplicate card that hasn't been entered yet.

Editing Inventory

Users may need to correct names, cost basis, notes, condition, or purchase details. Editing inventory is normal during cleanup. However, users should avoid changing historical records in ways that make past sales or tax records misleading.

Inventory Actions

Action	Use When
Edit	Information needs correction or more detail.
Sell	The item has been sold.
Giveaway	The item was used for promotion or marketing.
Dispose	The item was damaged, lost, unsellable, or removed without sale.
Search	The user needs to find inventory quickly.

Do Not Delete To Hide History

Users may be tempted to delete records when something goes wrong. In many business situations, it is better to reverse a sale, mark an item as disposed, record a giveaway, or use a restore point. Deleting can remove useful history and make reports harder to explain later.

Important: If the goal is to correct a mistake, choose the correction tool that preserves the clearest business history.

12. Selling Inventory

What Recording a Sale Does

Recording a sale is one of the most important workflows in HITS™. A sale is not just a note that money came in. It connects inventory, revenue, cost basis, fees, shipping, supplies, profit, reports, and HITS Pulse™ analytics.

Sale Fields Explained

Field	Meaning
Sale Price	The amount paid by the customer for the item.
Platform	Where the sale occurred, such as Whatnot, eBay, card show, or other.
Platform Fees	Marketplace, payment, or selling fees associated with the sale.
Shipping Charged	The shipping amount paid by the customer.
Postage	The actual cost paid to ship the item.
Supplies Cost	Mailers, envelopes, sleeves, top loaders, labels, or other shipping materials.
Notes	Useful context about the sale, buyer, issue, or correction.

Shipping Charged vs. Postage vs. Supplies Cost

These three fields must remain separate because they mean different things. Shipping Charged is money received from the customer. Postage is a cost paid by the seller. Supplies Cost is also a cost paid by the seller. Mixing them together makes profit reporting less accurate.

Example Sale

A card sells for \$25. The customer pays \$1.50 shipping. The platform fee is \$3.00. Actual postage costs \$0.69. Supplies cost \$0.25. The card cost \$10. HITS™ uses these values to calculate a much more realistic profit than sale price alone.

What Happens After Save

- Inventory is reduced or marked sold.
- Revenue is recorded.
- Realized cost of goods sold is calculated.
- Fees, postage, and supplies affect profit.

- Reports update.
- Anonymous HITS Pulse™ trend data may update.

Categories at Sale

Category selection during the sale process helps classify activity for reporting and HITS Pulse™. This is especially useful when the same account sells sports cards, TCG cards, memorabilia, comics, coins, toys, or other collectibles.

Sale Reversal

If a sale was recorded incorrectly, use sale reversal instead of manually recreating inventory from memory. Reversal restores the item so the user can correct the information and record the sale again if needed.

Common Sale Mistakes

- Entering postage in Shipping Charged.
- Forgetting platform fees.
- Leaving supplies cost blank when supplies were used.
- Selecting the wrong platform.
- Forgetting to reverse and re-enter an incorrect sale.

13. Shipping Profiles

What Shipping Profiles Are

Shipping Profiles store common shipping defaults for use during sale entry. They are especially helpful for repetitive shipping methods like PWE, BMWT, and international shipping.

Where To Find Shipping Profiles

Navigate to Settings -> Shipping Profiles. This is important: Shipping Profiles are accessed from Settings, not Utilities.

Fields

Field	Purpose
Profile Name	The label users select during sale entry, such as eBay PWE or BMWT.
Shipping Charged Default	Default amount charged to the customer.
Supplies Cost Default	Default cost of supplies used for that shipping method.

Creating a Profile

- 1 Open Settings -> Shipping Profiles.
- 2 Enter a profile name.
- 3 Enter the default shipping charged amount.
- 4 Enter the default supplies cost.
- 5 Save the profile.
- 6 Confirm it appears in the existing profiles list.

Editing a Profile

- 1 Open Settings -> Shipping Profiles.
- 2 Find the profile.
- 3 Select Edit.
- 4 Update the values.
- 5 Save the changes.

Editing a profile affects future sales. It does not rewrite past sales. This protects historical records from changing unexpectedly.

Suggested Profiles

- Whatnot PWE
- eBay PWE
- BMWT
- Card Show Pickup
- International
- Free Shipping Promotion

14. Expenses

What Expenses Are

Expenses are business costs that are not already captured as item cost basis, platform fees, postage, or supplies on a specific sale. Expenses should be recorded regularly so reports show a more accurate picture of net profit. If you use Quickbooks or another accounting software program, makes sure not to duplicate expenses.

Common Expense Categories

Category	Examples
Shipping Supplies	Bubble mailers, team bags, sleeves, top loaders, labels, tape.
Equipment	Printers, scanners, lighting, tables, storage, office equipment.
Subscriptions	Card Ladder, PSA, Beckett, inventory tools, software.
Advertising / Marketing	Promotions, giveaway-related costs, paid ads.
Postage	Postage not already recorded directly on sales.
Other	Business costs that do not fit another category.

Expense Entry Best Practices

- Record expenses soon after they occur.
- Use consistent categories.
- Add notes for unusual expenses.
- Avoid double-counting costs already recorded on a sale.
- Review expenses before locking a tax year.

Tax Reporting Importance

Expense tracking helps users understand profit and prepare better records for tax time. HITS™ can organize the information, but users should confirm tax treatment with a qualified tax professional.

15. Giveaways

What Giveaways Are

Giveaways are inventory items removed from available stock without a sale because they were used for promotion, marketing, customer appreciation, stream activity, or other business reasons. The item still had value, so it should be tracked rather than deleted.

Why Track Giveaways

Tracking giveaways creates a record of why inventory left the business. This is important for inventory accuracy, reporting, and explaining business activity later. A giveaway is different from a sale because no revenue is received, but the business still gave up inventory value.

Giveaway Workflow

- 1 Find the inventory item if already in system, if not add new inventory.
- 2 Choose the giveaway action.
- 3 Enter required notes.
- 4 Save the giveaway.
- 5 Confirm the item is no longer available inventory.

Good Notes

- What promotion or event caused the giveaway.
- Where the giveaway happened.
- Why the item was selected.
- Any details that would help explain the record later.

Example Note: Giveaway during Whatnot stream to promote upcoming baseball break. Item used as marketing/customer engagement.

Real-World Examples

2024 Topps Chrome Elly De La Cruz RC

Cost: \$4.00

Given away during a Whatnot stream.

Result:

Giveaway

Marketing-related activity

No longer available inventory

Giveaways vs Disposals

The Simple Rule

Giveaway = You intentionally gave the item away.

Examples:

- Whatnot stream givvy
- Customer appreciation bonus
- Promotional giveaway
- Contest prize
- Marketing item

Disposal = The item can no longer be sold.

Examples:

- Damaged card
- Lost inventory
- Water damage
- Thrown away
- Unsellable item

Why This Matters

Even though both remove the item from inventory, they mean very different things.

Giveaway

You chose to give it away.

The cost may support an advertising/marketing business expense.

Disposal

The item is no longer usable or sellable.

You are documenting a loss or inventory removal.

Why Notes Matter

This is probably the most important section.

Explain:

Bad:

Disposed

Good:

Card damaged during shipping prep.

Large corner crease discovered.

Item no longer saleable.

If somebody reviews records later, they need to understand why inventory disappeared.

Giveaway Walkthrough

Step 1

Go to:

Inventory

→ Giveaway

Step 2

Select the item.

Show:

- Player/Item Name
- Cost Basis
- Quantity

Step 3

Enter notes.

Examples:

Whatnot stream giveaway

Customer bonus

Discord contest prize

Explain:

Always leave a note. Six months from now you won't remember why the item disappeared.

Step 4

Save giveaway.

Show what happens:

- Inventory removed
- Status becomes Giveaway
- Available quantity becomes 0
- Item can no longer be sold

Giveaway Reporting

Show:

Reports

Explain:

- Giveaway activity appears in reports
- Cost basis is preserved
- Marketing activity can be reviewed later

Disposal Walkthrough

Step 1

Open inventory item.

Step 2

Choose:

Dispose Item

Step 3

Enter reason.

Examples:

Damaged

Lost

Destroyed

Water damage

Missing inventory

Step 4

Save.

Show what happens:

- Removed from available inventory
- Status becomes Disposed
- Item can no longer be sold
- Notes become part of records

Common Mistakes

Mistake #1

Using Giveaway for damaged inventory.

Wrong.

Use Disposal.

Mistake #2

Using Disposal for promotional givvies.

Wrong.

Use Giveaway.

Mistake #3

Giving away inventory and then trying to sell it later.

Once marked Giveaway:

Cannot be sold

Mistake #4

Leaving notes blank.

Always document:

Who

What

Why

16. Disposal and Write-Offs

What Disposal Means

Disposal removes inventory without a sale and without treating it as a giveaway. Use disposal when inventory is damaged, lost, destroyed, unsellable, or otherwise removed from the business.

Disposal Examples

- Damaged card discovered during sorting.
- Inventory lost in storage.
- Unsellable item discarded in trash or donated to children.
- Item destroyed or no longer usable.
- Personal removal that should no longer be business inventory.

Why Notes Matter

Disposal can affect inventory and reports, so notes are important. Months later, the user should be able to understand why an item left inventory. Detailed notes create an audit trail.

Disposal Workflow

- 1 Find the item in Inventory, oftentimes you marked as junk.
- 2 Choose Dispose or write-off action.
- 3 Enter detailed notes.
- 4 Save.
- 5 Review reports if needed.

Warning: Do not use disposal as a shortcut for correcting sales mistakes. Use sale reversal or editing tools when the item was sold incorrectly.

Example:

2023 Bowman Prospect
Cost: \$2.50
Bent and water damaged.
Result:
Disposed
No longer available inventory
Documented loss

17. Starting Inventory

What Starting Inventory Is

Starting Inventory is used to establish the value of inventory at the beginning of a tax year or when a user starts using HITS™ with existing inventory. This is common for users moving from spreadsheets, paper records, or another tracking system.

Why Starting Inventory Matters

Beginning inventory affects tax-year reporting. If a user already owns inventory before using HITS™, the system needs a starting point so reports can distinguish beginning value, new purchases, sold inventory, and ending inventory.

When To Use It

- The user had inventory before starting HITS™.
- The user is moving from a spreadsheet.
- The user is setting up the first tracked tax year.
- The user needs to establish beginning inventory for year-end reporting.

Starting Inventory Workflow

- 1 Navigate to the Starting Inventory or Tax Year Settings area.
- 2 Enter or review beginning inventory values.
- 3 Save the starting inventory information.
- 4 Confirm totals are correct.
- 5 Do not lock the year until the information has been reviewed.

Common Mistakes

- Leaving beginning inventory blank when the business already had inventory.
- Changing beginning inventory without understanding tax-year effects.
- Locking a tax year before reviewing starting values.

What If I Have Inventory but No Spreadsheet?

Many users start HITS™ with years of accumulated inventory but no existing spreadsheet or records. In this situation, you do not need to enter every item immediately.

You have two common options:

Option 1: Enter Everything Up Front (Most Accurate)

If time allows, enter all inventory before selling items. This provides the most accurate inventory tracking, cost basis reporting, and tax records from day one.

Option 2: Start Today and Enter Items As Needed (Most Common)

Many users choose to begin using HITS™ immediately and enter inventory as they sort, organize, or prepare items for sale. This allows users to start tracking new purchases, sales, expenses, and business activity without delaying setup.

When using this approach:

Continue adding inventory over time.

Enter items before they are sold whenever possible.

Use Starting Inventory to establish a beginning inventory value if known.

Keep notes explaining how beginning inventory was estimated.

Example:

A collector has accumulated 50,000 cards since childhood but has never tracked them in a spreadsheet. Rather than entering every card before using HITS™, the collector begins tracking all new purchases immediately and gradually adds older inventory as it is sorted and prepared for sale.

18. Tax Year Settings and Locking

What Tax Year Locking Does

Tax Year Locking preserves historical records for a completed year. When a year is locked, HITS™ preserves inventory snapshots and tax-related reporting information so completed periods do not continue changing unexpectedly.

Before Locking

A tax year should only be locked after the user has reviewed the year. Locking too early can create confusion if important records are missing.

- All inventory entered.
- All sales entered.
- All expenses entered.
- Giveaways recorded.
- Disposals recorded.
- Action Needed reviewed.
- Reports reviewed.
- Restore point created.

Inventory Snapshots

When a tax year is locked, HITS™ creates or preserves inventory snapshot records. These help document the year-end position and provide support for reporting. Snapshot records are part of the system history.

Unlocking

If the system allows unlocking, it should be used carefully. Unlocking a year means the user intends to change records that may affect historical reporting. A restore point should be created before unlocking or changing locked-year data.

Best Practice

Year-End Rule: Review first, export second, lock third. Do not lock a tax year until records and reports have been reviewed.

19. Backup and Restore Points

What Restore Points Are

Restore Points are checkpoints that help recover from mistakes or unwanted changes. They are designed to protect business data during normal work, imports, edits, deletes, restore operations, and tax-related actions.

What Gets Backed Up

- Inventory records.
- Sales records.
- Expense records.
- Orders and imported purchase records.
- Shipping Profiles.
- Tax Settings.
- Business records and transaction history relevant to the restore process.

Automatic Restore Points

HITS™ can create restore points automatically when major business activity occurs. Examples include inventory changes, sales, imports, transactions, and tax-related actions. Users do not need to manually create every checkpoint.

*Please note that restore points may not show up immediately, it sometimes takes 15-30 mins.

Scheduled Restore Points

The system also maintains scheduled protection, including daily restore points and monthly retention checkpoints. These are processed automatically in the background.

Manual Restore Points

Manual restore points are created by the user. They are recommended before large imports, major cleanup, tax-year locking, deleting records, or other significant changes.

Restore Point Types

Type	Meaning
Manual	Created by the user.
Automatic	Created by system activity.
Scheduled	Created by scheduled checkpoint processing.

Before Import	Created before import-related changes.
Before Delete	Created before deletion-related changes.
Before Restore	Created before restoring data.
Before Tax Lock	Created before tax-year locking activity.

Restoring Data

- 1 Navigate to Utilities -> Backup & Restore.
- 2 Review available restore points.
- 3 Select the checkpoint to restore.
- 4 Confirm the timestamp and type.
- 5 Start the restore.
- 6 After completion, verify the affected data.

Restore Point FAQ

I made a sale but do not see a restore point immediately.

Restore points are processed automatically on a schedule and may appear shortly after changes are made. This is normal.

Should I still create manual restore points?

Yes. Automatic checkpoints help, but manual restore points are useful before major changes because the user knows exactly why the checkpoint was created.

20. Reports Center

What Reports Center Does

Reports Center turns business activity into useful information. Inventory, sales, expenses, shipping, platform fees, giveaways, disposals, and tax settings all feed into reports. Reports are only as good as the records behind them, which is why complete data entry matters.

Financial Reports

Report	Purpose
Profit & Loss	Shows revenue, cost of goods sold, expenses, and net profit.
Realized COGS	Shows cost basis connected to completed sales.
Sales Tax	Summarizes taxable sales activity and marketplace/user liability.
CPA Packet	Collects year-end support information for tax preparers.

Inventory Reports

- Inventory Summary: shows current inventory status and values.
- Open Lots: helps review inventory that remains unsold or open.
- Inventory status views: help identify available, sold, disposed, and giveaway items.

Sales Reports

- Sales Activity: completed sales and performance.
- Platform Performance: results by marketplace or sales channel.
- Break Profitability: performance analysis for break-style purchasing/selling workflows.

Operations Reports

Operations reports help users find workflow problems. Action Needed is especially important because it highlights incomplete records that can affect reporting.

Exports

Reports may support CSV, PDF, and print exports depending on the page. Exported reports can be used for review, records, and CPA preparation.

Report Best Practices

- Review reports monthly, not just at tax time.
- Fix Action Needed items before relying on totals.
- Export year-end reports before locking the tax year.
- Provide CPA Packet information to tax preparers when appropriate.

21. HITS Pulse™

What HITS Pulse™ Is

HITS Pulse™ provides anonymous hobby trend analytics based on completed sales activity within the app. It is intended to help users see broad market activity without exposing private seller information.

Privacy

HITS Pulse™ does not display usernames, emails, seller names, or private identities. It focuses on anonymous trend information such as top selling players, categories, and movement over time so that you can see what is selling the best right now.

How To Interpret It

Pulse data should be treated as trend information, not a guarantee of value. It can help users identify activity but should be combined with judgment, current comps, inventory strategy, and business goals.

Examples

- Top selling players over a selected period.
- Category trends such as sports cards or TCG.
- Movement in sales activity over time.

22. Action Needed and Troubleshooting

What Action Needed Means

Action Needed indicates that HITS™ found records that may be incomplete. These items should be reviewed because missing data can affect reports, profits, tax support, or workflow accuracy.

Common Action Needed Items

Issue	Why It Matters
Missing Cost Basis	Profit and tax reporting may be inaccurate.
Missing Platform	Sales channel reports may be incomplete.
Missing Shipping Values	Profit calculations may be incomplete.
Missing Notes for Disposal/Giveaway	Business history may be harder to explain.

Troubleshooting Imports

- Confirm the file is the correct export.
- Check whether the order was skipped as a duplicate.
- Look for missing required fields.
- Try a small test import before a large batch.
- Use restore points when a bad import creates unwanted data.

Troubleshooting Sales

- Confirm the correct inventory item was selected.
- Check sale price and platform fees.
- Verify Shipping Charged, Postage, and Supplies Cost are in the correct fields.
- Use sale reversal if the sale was entered incorrectly.

Troubleshooting Restore Points

- Remember that automatic restore points may appear shortly after activity.
- Manual restore points are best before major changes.
- Review timestamp and type before restoring.
- Create a restore point before making additional cleanup changes.

23. Best Practices

Daily Habits

- Enter new purchases or imports promptly upon package receipt.
- Process Orders Received regularly.
- Record sales as soon as possible.
- Use Shipping Profiles to reduce repetitive entry.

Weekly Habits

- Review Action Needed.
- Search for obvious duplicate inventory.
- Check recent sales and profit results.
- Add missing expense records.

Monthly Habits

- Review Profit & Loss.
- Review expenses and subscriptions.
- Check inventory value and open lots.
- Create a manual restore point before cleanup work.

Data Entry Consistency

The system is easier to use when users are consistent. Use similar names, categories, platform labels, and notes. The goal is not to make every record perfect; the goal is to make records understandable later.

When In Doubt, Add Notes

Notes are useful when business records need explanation. If a purchase, sale, disposal, or giveaway might be confusing months later, add a note when the event happens so you can recall it when and if you need to.

24. Year-End Checklist

Before Year-End Review

- Make sure all inventory purchases are entered.
- Make sure all sales are recorded.
- Make sure expenses are recorded.
- Record giveaways and disposals.
- Review Action Needed.

Reports To Review

- Profit & Loss.
- Realized COGS.
- Sales Tax.
- Inventory Summary.
- Open Lots.
- CPA Packet.

Before Locking The Year

- 1 Create a restore point.
- 2 Export important reports.
- 3 Review beginning and ending inventory.
- 4 Review sales and expense totals.
- 5 Confirm giveaways and disposals have notes.
- 6 Lock the tax year only after review.

After Locking

After a tax year is locked, avoid making unnecessary changes to historical records. If changes are required, create a restore point first and understand how the change may affect reports.

25. Glossary

Term	Definition
Cost Basis	The amount paid for an item or allocated to an item.
Beginning Inventory	Inventory value at the start of a tax year.
Ending Inventory	Inventory value at the end of a tax year.
Realized COGS	Cost of goods sold tied to completed sales.
Shipping Charged	Amount paid by the customer for shipping.
Postage	Actual shipping cost paid by the seller.
Supplies Cost	Packaging and shipping material cost.
Platform Fees	Marketplace or payment fees.
Giveaway	Inventory removed for promotion or marketing without sale revenue.
Disposal	Inventory removed because it is damaged, lost, unsellable, or otherwise not sold.
Restore Point	A checkpoint used to recover business data.
Tax Year Lock	A year-end action that preserves historical reporting and snapshots.
CPA Packet	A collection of reports intended to support tax preparation.

26. End-to-End Whatnot Purchase Workflow

Purpose of This Workflow

Many HITS™ users will begin by importing Whatnot purchases. The goal is to bring purchase records into HITS™, organize them, process them into inventory, and eventually record sales against that inventory. This chapter describes the complete path from purchase file to active inventory.

Step 1: Export Whatnot Purchases

Start with the marketplace export file. The file should be complete and should represent the purchases the user wants to bring into HITS™. If the export appears empty, partial, or incorrectly formatted, stop and export again before uploading. This can be found in your activity and at the bottom when clicking download order history on a PC. Save it to a place you can find it later. It defaults to downloads usually.

Step 2: Import Into HITS™

- 1 Open Orders -> Import Orders.
- 2 Upload the Whatnot export file.
- 3 Wait for the import result.
- 4 Read the imported, skipped, duplicate, and error counts.
- 5 Do not move forward until the import result makes sense.

Step 3: Review Duplicates and Skipped Records

Duplicate protection is intentional. If the same file is uploaded twice, HITS™ should avoid creating duplicate orders. Skipped records are not automatically bad. They may indicate that the system protected the account from repeated import data. There is a warning if there is an error.

Step 4: Combine When Helpful

If multiple Whatnot purchases belong to the same stream, shipment, or buying session, use Combine Orders when it simplifies the receiving process. Do not combine unrelated purchases just because they appear near each other in the list.

Step 5: Process Through Orders Received

Imported purchases become useful inventory only after they are processed through Orders Received. Open the received order or group, enter the item information, assign cost basis, and save inventory records.

Step 6: Verify Inventory

After saving, go to Inventory and search for the newly created items. Confirm the names, costs, and notes look correct. This verification step catches mistakes before items are sold.

Step 7: Record Sales Later

When inventory sells, record the sale from Inventory. HITS™ will use the cost basis entered during inventory creation to calculate profit and realized COGS.

Workflow Reminder: Whatnot import does not equal inventory. Import creates purchase/order records. Inventory is created when the user processes those records into inventory.

27. Card Show and In-Person Purchase Workflow

When This Workflow Applies

Not every purchase comes from an online marketplace. Card show purchases, cash purchases, trade-night deals, and local collection buys may not have a clean import file. HITS™ still supports these purchases through manual inventory entry or bulk import.

Single Item Purchase

- 1 Open Inventory.
- 2 Create a new inventory item.
- 3 Enter Player/Item Name.
- 4 Enter the amount paid as Cost.
- 5 Add brand, year, condition, and notes.
- 6 Save the item.

Multiple Item Purchase

If several items are purchased together, the user should decide whether each item needs its own record or whether the purchase should be tracked as a lot. High-value items usually deserve individual records. Low-value bulk may be easier to track as a lot.

Allocating Cost

When a group is purchased for one total price, the total cost should be allocated in a reasonable way. For example, a \$100 purchase containing four meaningful items might be split as \$40, \$30, \$20, and \$10 if that reflects relative value. The goal is to avoid zero-cost inventory when the business actually paid for the items.

Notes for In-Person Purchases

Notes are especially useful for in-person purchases because there may be no marketplace order number. Good notes might include the show name, seller name if appropriate, date, table location, or a reminder that the item came from a larger collection purchase.

Example Note: Purchased at Rapid City card show as part of \$120 mixed baseball lot. Cost allocated based on estimated item value at time of entry.

28. Existing Collection and Parent Basement Workflow

Purpose

Some users will start HITS™ after already owning inventory. They may have cards in storage, old boxes at home, items from a personal collection that are becoming business inventory, or inventory from a previous spreadsheet. The goal is to bring that inventory into HITS™ with enough cost basis information to make future reports useful.

Decide What Belongs in Business Inventory

Not every personal collectible needs to become business inventory. Users should enter items they intend to sell or track as part of the business. Personal collection items that are not for sale may not need to be entered.

Choose Entry Method

- Manual Entry: best for a small number of important items.
- Bulk Import: best for spreadsheet migration or large batches.
- Starting Inventory: best for establishing beginning value at the start of a tax year.

Cost Basis Challenge

Existing collection items may not have perfect purchase records. Users should use the best available records, such as receipts, old spreadsheets, marketplace history, or reasonable allocation from collection purchases. If cost basis is uncertain, notes should explain the situation.

Do Not Ignore Cost

Entering old inventory with zero cost may make future sales look artificially profitable. If the business paid for the item, the user should make a reasonable effort to enter cost basis.

29. Inventory Field Reference

Purpose of Field Reference

This section explains common inventory fields in plain language so users understand why a field exists and when to use it.

Field	Use It For	Helpful Example
Player/Item Name	Primary searchable item identity.	Ken Griffey Jr.; Charizard; 2024 Topps Chrome Box
Cost	Cost basis for profit and tax support.	\$5.00 purchase cost
Quantity	Number of identical or grouped items.	10-card lot quantity 10
Brand	Product line or manufacturer.	Topps Chrome; Panini Prizm; Pokémon
Year	Product year or release year.	1989; 2024; 2025
Card Number	Card or item number when applicable.	#1; US100
Condition	Raw, graded, damaged, sealed, etc.	PSA 10; Near Mint; Damaged
Purchased From	Where the item was acquired.	Whatnot; eBay; Card Show
Platform	Purchase or sales channel when relevant.	Whatnot
Order Number	Marketplace or internal source reference.	Marketplace order ID
Notes	Context that may matter later.	Part of \$500 collection purchase

Required vs Optional

Only Player/Item Name and Cost are required for basic inventory entry. Optional fields are still valuable because they make search, reporting, and future sales entry easier. A user can start with minimal data and improve records later.

What To Do When Information Is Unknown

If a field is unknown, leave it blank rather than guessing, unless a reasonable estimate is appropriate for cost allocation. Add notes when the missing information may matter later.

30. Sale Entry Field Reference

Purpose

Sale entry fields affect revenue, profit, cost of goods sold, shipping analysis, platform reporting, and tax support. Users should understand each field before recording large volumes of sales.

Field	What To Enter	Common Mistake
Sale Price	Price paid for the item.	Entering price plus unrelated shipping incorrectly.
Platform	Where the sale happened.	Leaving blank, causing Action Needed.
Platform Fees	Marketplace/payment fees.	Forgetting fees and overstating profit.
Shipping Charged	What buyer paid for shipping.	Entering actual postage here.
Postage	What seller paid carrier.	Leaving blank when label was purchased.
Supplies Cost	Packaging material cost.	Ignoring small costs that add up.
Shipping Profile	Preset defaults for shipping charged/supplies.	Assuming it changes past sales.
Category	Sale category for reports and Pulse.	Wrong category selected.
Notes	Context or exceptions.	No note for unusual sale.

Profit Example

A \$50 sale with \$5 shipping charged is not simply \$55 of profit. HITS™ also considers cost basis, platform fees, postage, and supplies. If the item cost \$25, fees were \$6, postage was \$4, and supplies were \$0.75, the real profit picture is much different from the gross sale amount.

Review Before Saving

Users should pause before saving a sale and check sale price, platform, fees, shipping charged, postage, supplies, category, and notes. Correct sale data reduces cleanup later.

31. Expense Field Reference

Purpose

Expenses help track business costs that are not already directly tied to a specific sale. Consistent expense entry makes Profit & Loss reporting more useful.

Field	Meaning
Date	When the expense occurred.
Amount	Cost paid by the business.
Category	Expense type such as supplies, equipment, subscription, marketing, postage, or other.
Vendor / Purchased From	Where the expense was paid.
Notes	Additional context for tax review or business records.

Avoid Double Counting

If postage or supplies are already entered on a specific sale, users should be careful not to also enter the same cost as a separate general expense. Some supplies are purchased in bulk and entered as expenses; others may be assigned per sale. The important thing is consistency.

Marketing and Giveaways

Giveaways can be tied to advertising or marketing activity. Users should record the inventory removal and include notes. Separate promotional expenses, such as paid ads or event costs, can be entered as expenses.

32. Detailed Report Reference

Profit & Loss

The Profit & Loss report summarizes revenue, cost of goods sold, expenses, and net profit. This is one of the main business health reports. Users should review it monthly and at year end.

Realized COGS

Realized COGS focuses on the cost basis of items that actually sold. Unsold inventory is not realized COGS. This distinction matters because inventory may be purchased in one period and sold in another.

Sales Tax

The Sales Tax report helps review taxable sales activity and distinguish marketplace-collected tax from situations where the user may be responsible. Users should confirm sales tax requirements with a professional or local authority.

CPA Packet

The CPA Packet is intended to make tax preparation easier by gathering useful year-end information. It should support, not replace, professional review.

Inventory Summary

Inventory Summary shows current inventory status and value. It helps users understand what remains available, what has been sold, and what needs cleanup.

Open Lots

Open Lots helps users review unsold or unresolved lot-style inventory. This is helpful for sellers who buy breaks, collections, or bulk inventory.

Platform Performance

Platform Performance helps compare sales channels. For example, a user may want to know whether Whatnot, eBay, card shows, or another platform is producing better results.

Operations and Action Needed

Operations reports focus on workflow health. Action Needed is not just an error list; it is a cleanup guide for better records.

33. Common Correction Scenarios

I Recorded a Sale Incorrectly

- 1 Locate the sale.
- 2 Use Reverse Sale if available.
- 3 Confirm inventory was restored.
- 4 Correct the item or sale details.
- 5 Record the sale again with accurate information.

I Imported the Wrong File

- 1 Stop entering additional data.
- 2 Review what was imported.
- 3 Check for automatic or manual restore points.
- 4 Restore if needed.
- 5 Import the correct file only after recovery is complete.

An Item Is Missing Cost Basis

- 1 Open Action Needed or locate the item.
- 2 Edit the inventory record.
- 3 Enter the correct cost or best available cost basis.
- 4 Add notes if the amount is estimated or allocated.
- 5 Save and recheck reports.

Shipping Values Look Wrong

Check whether Shipping Charged, Postage, and Supplies Cost were entered in the correct fields. Shipping Charged is customer-paid revenue. Postage and supplies are seller costs.

34. Beta Tester Quick Start

Goal

This quick start is for beta testers who want to validate the core workflow without reading the entire manual first.

- 1 Create an account and log in.
- 2 Create at least one Shipping Profile under Settings -> Shipping Profiles.
- 3 Import a small order file or manually create a few inventory items.
- 4 If importing, process the records through Orders Received.
- 5 Confirm inventory appears in Inventory.
- 6 Record one test sale.
- 7 Review Reports Center.
- 8 Check Action Needed.
- 9 Create a manual restore point.
- 10 Review Backup & Restore.
- 11 Do not lock a tax year until data has been reviewed.

What Beta Testers Should Watch For

- Unexpected import results.
- Duplicate records.
- Fields that are confusing.
- Reports that do not match expectations.
- Action Needed items that are unclear.
- Restore points that are not understandable.
- Navigation labels that do not match the guide.

35. Support Information To Provide When Asking For Help

Why Details Matter

When asking for support, users should include enough detail for the issue to be understood. Vague reports such as "it did not work" are hard to diagnose. Clear reports reduce back-and-forth and speed up fixes.

Helpful Details

- Page name.
- What the user clicked.
- What the user expected to happen.
- What actually happened.
- Any error message or screenshot.
- Whether the issue happened after import, sale, restore, or tax-year action.
- Whether the user refreshed or retried.

Good Support Example

"On Settings -> Shipping Profiles, I edited BMWT from \$5.99 to \$6.99 and clicked Update Profile. The page showed an update error. Creating a new profile still works. I refreshed and tried again with the same result."

Poor Support Example

"Shipping is broken."

36. Detailed FAQ

Why did my order import but not show in Inventory?

Orders and inventory are separate on purpose. Importing a purchase creates order or receiving records. Inventory is created later when the user processes those records through Orders Received or enters inventory details. This prevents imported purchases from becoming active inventory before the user has reviewed them.

Why is an item showing Action Needed?

Action Needed means HITS™ found a record that may be incomplete. The most common causes are missing cost basis, missing platform, missing shipping values, or missing notes for removal actions. Review the record and complete the missing information.

What should I do before a large import?

Create a manual restore point, confirm the file is correct, and test with a smaller batch if possible. Review import results carefully before processing the records further.

Can I edit records later?

Many records can be edited, but users should be careful with historical records that affect reports. If the record is tied to a completed sale or locked tax year, review the possible effect before changing it.

Can HITS™ replace spreadsheets?

For many hobby sellers, yes. HITS™ is designed to replace spreadsheet-based inventory, sales, profit, and tax tracking. Some users may still export reports for accountants, backups, or personal analysis.

37. New User Training Walkthrough

Training Goal

This walkthrough teaches the core workflow using a small amount of test data. A new user should complete this before using HITS™ for a large batch of real inventory.

Step A: Create Shipping Profile

- 1 Go to Settings -> Shipping Profiles.
- 2 Create a profile named Test PWE.
- 3 Enter a small Shipping Charged default.
- 4 Enter a small Supplies Cost default.
- 5 Save the profile.

Step B: Create Inventory

- 1 Go to Inventory.
- 2 Create a test item with Player/Item Name and Cost.
- 3 Add a note that this is a training item if needed.
- 4 Save it.
- 5 Search for it to confirm it exists.

Step C: Record Sale

- 1 Open the test item.
- 2 Choose Sell.
- 3 Enter a sale price.
- 4 Select platform.
- 5 Select the shipping profile.
- 6 Confirm shipping fields populate.
- 7 Enter fees and postage.
- 8 Save the sale.

Step D: Review Reports

- 1 Open Reports Center.
- 2 Review Profit & Loss.

- 3 Review Realized COGS.
- 4 Check Action Needed.
- 5 Confirm the test sale affected reports.

Step E: Reverse If Needed

If this was only a training sale, use sale reversal if available or delete/clean up according to the testing process being used. The important training point is to see how inventory, sales, and reports connect.

38. Data Quality Standards

Why Standards Matter

A system like HITS™ becomes more valuable as records become more consistent. Inconsistent names, missing costs, skipped notes, and messy categories do not always break the app, but they make reports and searches less useful.

Naming Standard

Use names that are short, searchable, and consistent. For sports cards, use the player name in Player/Item Name and place product-specific information in brand, year, card number, or notes. For sealed products, use a clear product name.

Cost Standard

Every inventory item should have cost basis whenever possible. If exact cost is unknown, use the best available information and add notes. Do not use zero unless the item truly had no cost to the business.

Notes Standard

Notes should explain things that would not be obvious later. Examples include collection allocation, damaged item reason, giveaway promotion, unusual sale arrangement, or manual correction.

Review Standard

Review Action Needed weekly, reports monthly, and tax-year records before locking. Regular review turns cleanup into a small routine instead of a tax-season emergency.

39. Import Cleanup Guide

When Cleanup Is Needed

Import cleanup may be needed when a file contains unexpected rows, duplicate-looking data, missing information, or records that need to be combined before inventory entry.

Cleanup Process

- 1 Do not continue processing blindly.
- 2 Review import results.
- 3 Identify whether the problem is duplicates, errors, wrong file, or missing information.
- 4 Check whether a restore point exists before the import.
- 5 Decide whether to fix manually, re-import, or restore.

Duplicate-Looking Records

Sometimes records look similar because the user purchased multiple similar items. Other times they are true duplicates. Use order numbers, timestamps, notes, and source information to decide.

Re-Upload After Fixing

If the user fixes a CSV and uploads it again, duplicate protection should prevent already imported rows from duplicating when possible. Users should still review results carefully.

When To Restore

Restoring is appropriate when the import created widespread unwanted changes and cleanup would be slower or riskier than returning to a checkpoint. Always review the restore point timestamp and type before confirming.

40. Sales Cleanup Guide

Incorrect Sale Price

If the wrong sale price was entered, review whether the sale can be edited directly or should be reversed and re-entered. The safest workflow is often to reverse the sale and record it correctly so inventory and realized COGS remain clear.

Wrong Shipping Values

Check whether customer-paid shipping was entered as Shipping Charged and seller-paid postage was entered as Postage. Supplies Cost should reflect packaging materials, not the carrier label.

Wrong Platform

Platform mistakes affect platform reports. Correct the sale record if editing is available. If the sale history is confusing, add notes explaining the correction.

Wrong Item Sold

If the wrong inventory item was sold, reverse the sale so the wrong item returns to inventory. Then sell the correct item. This avoids manually rebuilding inventory history.

Missing Fees

Missing platform fees overstate profit. Users should add fees when known. If marketplace fee totals are not available immediately, the user may need to update the sale later.

41. Tax Preparation Workflow

Monthly Preparation

Tax preparation is easier when users maintain records throughout the year. Monthly review should include sales, expenses, Action Needed, inventory values, and unusual removals such as giveaways or disposals.

Pre-Year-End Review

- 1 Review Action Needed.
- 2 Confirm cost basis on important inventory.
- 3 Review expenses and categories.
- 4 Review sales tax report.
- 5 Review giveaways and disposals.
- 6 Create a restore point.
- 7 Export preliminary reports.

CPA Review

The CPA Packet and reports are intended to help the user and tax preparer review business activity. A CPA may ask for additional information, but HITS™ should reduce the amount of manual reconstruction needed.

After Filing

After records are reviewed and any necessary corrections are made, the user can lock the tax year to preserve historical records. Do not lock before review is complete.

42. Sales Tax Concepts

Marketplace Collected vs User Liable

Some marketplaces may collect and remit sales tax on behalf of the seller. Other sales, such as card show transactions, may require the user to track liability differently. HITS™ helps organize sales tax information, but users should confirm requirements for their location and business situation.

Why Platform Matters

Platform is important because sales tax responsibility may differ by sales channel. A marketplace sale and an in-person sale may not be treated the same way.

What To Review

- Sales by platform.
- Marketplace collected amounts when available.
- Card show or direct sales.
- Taxable sales totals.
- Exported sales tax reports.

Important Reminder

HITS™ organizes records. It does not replace professional tax advice. Sales tax rules vary and can change. Users should verify requirements with a qualified professional or state/local authority.

43. CPA Packet Preparation

Purpose

The CPA Packet is designed to give tax preparers a cleaner starting point. Instead of sending a pile of screenshots, spreadsheets, and marketplace downloads, users can export organized reports from HITS™.

What To Include

- Profit & Loss report.
- Realized COGS report.
- Expense summary.
- Sales tax report.
- Inventory summary.
- Starting and ending inventory information.
- Giveaway and disposal records when relevant.

How To Prepare

- 1 Review Action Needed.
- 2 Correct missing cost basis and platform values.
- 3 Review expenses.
- 4 Create a restore point.
- 5 Export reports.
- 6 Lock the tax year only after review.

Questions a CPA May Ask

- How was cost basis determined?
- Were marketplace taxes collected?
- What inventory remains unsold?
- What expenses were business related?
- Why was inventory disposed or given away?

44. Safe Change Checklist

Before Major Changes

- Create a manual restore point.
- Confirm which records will be affected.
- Export reports if the change affects tax history.
- Avoid making multiple unrelated changes at once.

During Major Changes

- Work slowly.
- Check results after each major action.
- Do not ignore errors.
- Do not keep retrying a failing action without understanding the message.

After Major Changes

- Review affected records.
- Check reports.
- Check Action Needed.
- Create another restore point if the result is correct and important.

Examples of Major Changes

- Large import.
- Bulk cleanup.
- Tax year lock or unlock.
- Restore operation.
- Deleting records.
- Major category or cost-basis correction.

45. Distribution Notes for Beta Users

What Beta Means

Beta Edition means the system is usable but still being refined. Users should expect improvements, occasional label changes, and additional documentation updates. The purpose of beta testing is to identify unclear workflows, missing help text, and edge cases before wider release.

How To Give Useful Feedback

- Describe the page and workflow.
- Explain what you expected.
- Explain what happened.
- Include the exact error message when possible.
- Mention whether the issue happened during import, sale, restore, report export, or tax-year action.

What To Test First

- Account creation and login.
- Shipping Profiles.
- Small inventory entry.
- Small import.
- Orders Received.
- Sale entry.
- Reports Center.
- Restore Points.
- Action Needed.

What Not To Do During First Test

- Do not start with the largest file you have.
- Do not ignore restore points before major changes.
- Do not lock tax years before reviewing records.
- Do not delete records just because something looks wrong.

46. Quick Reference Checklists

Before Importing Orders

- Confirm the file is the correct marketplace export.
- Create a manual restore point for large imports.
- Upload the file once.
- Review imported, skipped, duplicate, and error counts.
- Do not process orders until the result makes sense.

Before Recording a Sale

- Confirm the correct inventory item is selected.
- Enter sale price.
- Select platform.
- Enter platform fees.
- Select a shipping profile if applicable.
- Confirm Shipping Charged, Postage, and Supplies Cost.
- Select category and add notes if needed.

Before Locking a Tax Year

- Review inventory.
- Review sales.
- Review expenses.
- Review giveaways and disposals.
- Review Action Needed.
- Export important reports.
- Create a manual restore point.
- Lock only after review is complete.

Before Restoring Data

- Stop other work.
- Identify the problem.
- Review available restore points.

- Choose the correct timestamp.
- Understand that restoring changes business data.
- Verify results after restore.

Weekly Maintenance Checklist

- Process new orders.
- Enter cost basis for new inventory.
- Record sales.
- Enter expenses.
- Review Action Needed.
- Review recent reports.

Video Tutorials to come...